

Keil

2019, Luis Bolaños Mures, <https://boardgamegeek.com/boardgame/295889/keil>

Keil is a Go-like territory game for two players: Black and White. It is played on the intersections (*points*) of an initially empty hexagonal grid of triangles (*board*).

Apart from the board, Keil differs from Go in the idea of linking points, which preserves crosscuts and ko by reducing the natural connectivity of the triangular grid.

Definitions

- Two adjacent points, and any stones on them, are *linked* if there is another point adjacent to both that is the same type as at least one of them. Two points are the same type if they are either both empty or both occupied by stones of the same color.
- A *group* is a stone along with all other stones one can reach from it through a series of steps onto linked stones of its color.
- A *liberty* of a group is an empty point linked to at least one stone in that group.
- Similarly, a *territory* is an empty point along with all other empty points one can reach from it through a series of steps onto linked empty points. You *own* a territory if all stones linked to points in that territory are of your color.

Play

Black plays first, then turns alternate. On your turn, pass or place a stone of your color on an empty point. After a placement, remove all enemy stones in groups without liberties. After all removals, the stone you placed must be part of a group with at least one liberty, and the current board position must be different from the board positions at the end of all your previous turns. Otherwise, your placement is illegal.

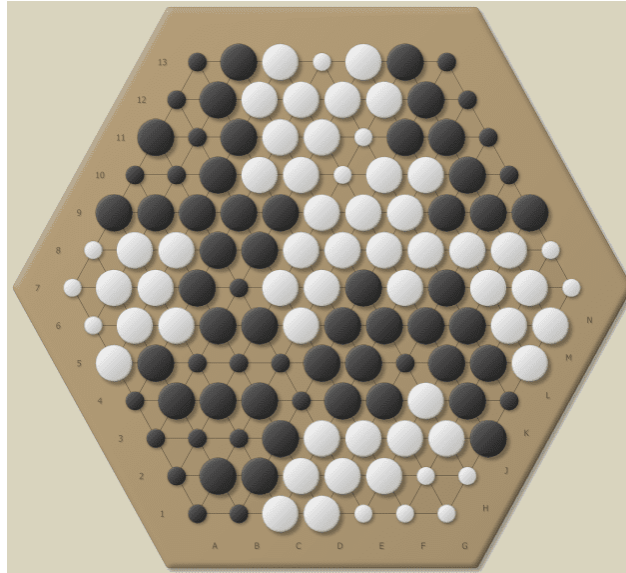
The game ends when both players pass in succession. The player with the higher score in the final position wins. Your *score* is the number of stones of your color on the board, plus the number of points in your territories, plus komi in the case of White. The button is used to avoid ties.

Komi and button

Komi is the whole number of points that is added to White's score at the end of the game as compensation for playing second. Before the game starts, the first player chooses the value of komi, and then the second player chooses sides.

Alternatively, experienced players may agree on a standard value for all games.

The *button* is a special token that is placed next to the board at the start of the game. On your turn, if neither player has taken the button yet, you may not pass, but you may take the button instead of making a board play. At the end of the game, a half point is added to the score of the player who has taken the button. When checking for repetitions, two identical board positions are still considered different if the button had already been taken in one of them but not in the other.

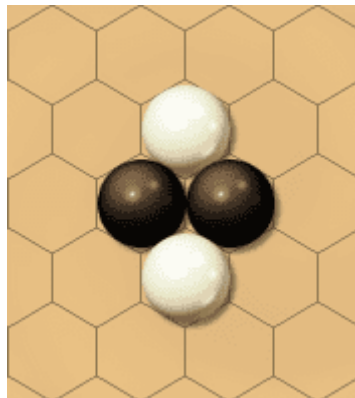


Position at the end of a Keil game. The small circles represent territory points. Black won by 0.5 points, with 67 points to White's 66.5. Komi was 6; the button was taken by White.

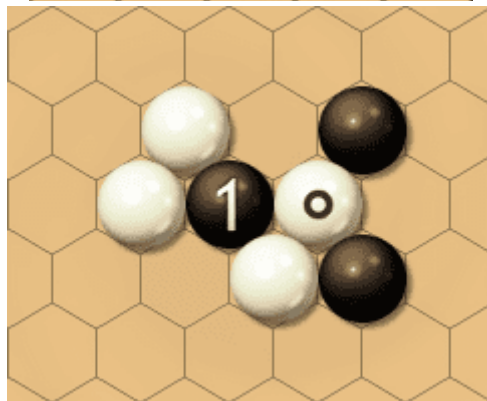
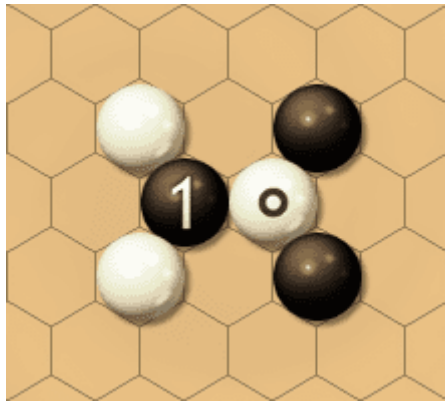
[BGG description]

Also, from <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/2307625>

A crosscut looks like this:

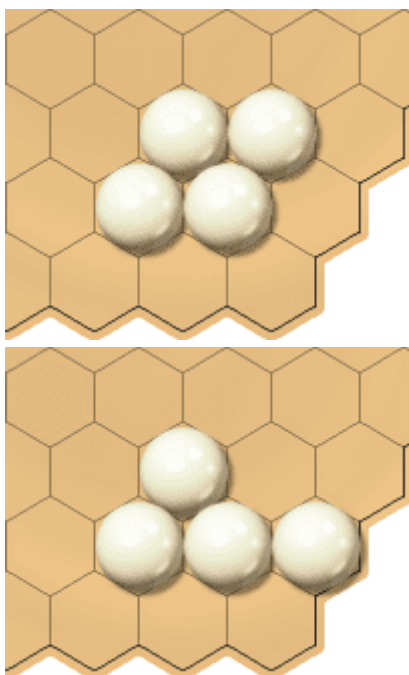


And here are some ko shapes:

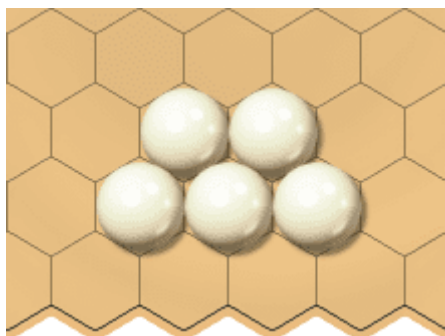


In all cases, Black can start the ko by playing at 1 and removing the marked white stone.

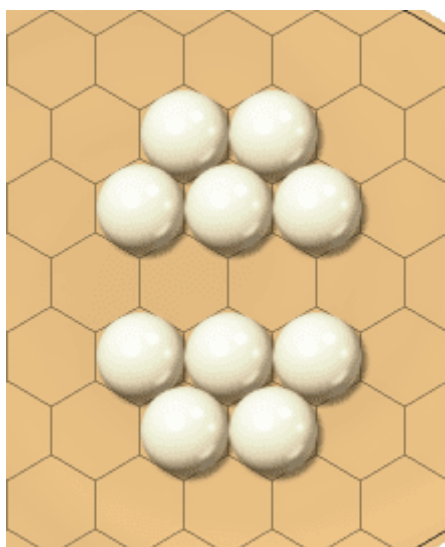
These are the smallest living shapes in the corner:



This is the smallest living shape on the edge of the board:

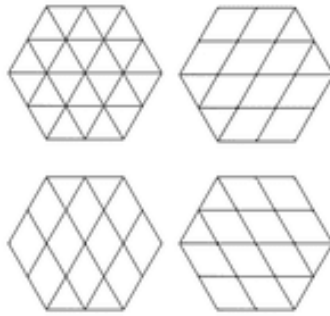


And here is the smallest living shape in the middle of the board:



@[hoembla](#) proposed, in 2024, a similar HexGo game, **Lozengo**:

You can overlay a square grid on a hex grid three different ways:



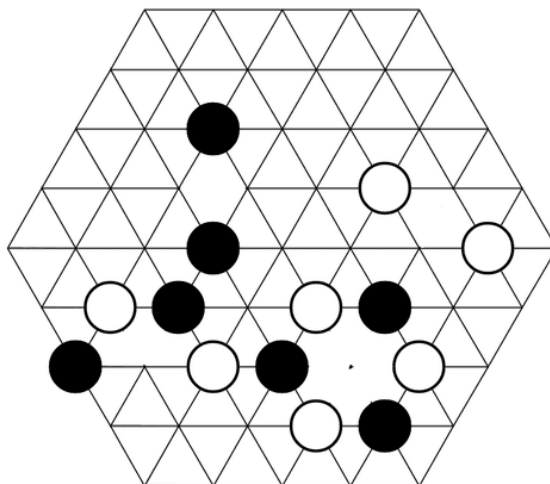
What if we let something about the local situation determine which square grid "counts" locally there?

Rules.

- Standard rules of Go on a hex board, but:
- For each lozenge (diamond), a pair of like-coloured stones at the sharp (acute) corners invalidates the connection between the blunt (obtuse) corners, if these stones are there.
- Rosette rule (optional): A site fully surrounded by six stones of the same colour gets all its connections back.

Score with area scoring. Suicide is allowed.

A lozenge is a set of four sites consisting of two triangles overlapping at an edge. Some examples of lozenges with the invalidated edge removed:



Comparison with Keil. Obviously quite similar to [Keil](#) by Luis Bolaños Mures, it may have even come about in an attempt to understand Keil better. Some of the same crosscuts and ko shapes that work in Keil work in Lozenge as well. The

behaviour at the edges and corners is different, though: in Keil, a row of stones on the 2nd line will cause the edge sites underneath to become disconnected from each other, providing a row of corner-like (in square board terms) eyes, while in Lozenge the edge cells always remain connected to each other. Similarly in Keil you can enclose a corner cell with one stone, while in Lozenge you can only flank a corner with two stones.

In 2025, Dale Walton [proposed Meshes](#), another restricted HexGo variant:

Rules.

Play is like Go, except as noted:

- Liberties are considered for each stone:
 - If there is a way to step from a stone, adjacently stone-to-stone, to an empty cell without stepping on an enemy stone, nor crossing a diagonal between enemy stones, then that stone is alive.
 - If not, it is dead.
- After placement, all enemy dead stones are removed simultaneously.
- Suicide is not allowed.
- Super-Ko applies.

